Sarcococca confusa

Sweet Box, Christmas Box, Fragrant Sarcococca

Family: Buxaceae

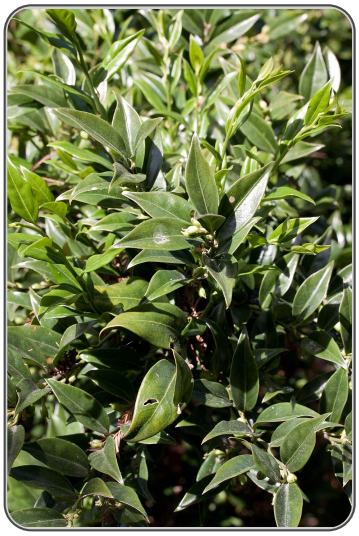
Overlook: 19 | Wonderland: 32 | Piedmont: 60 | **TOTAL 111**



HABIT



OTHER



LEAF



FLOWER

QUICK FACTS

Plant Type: Shrub

Evergreen or deciduous
Evergreen

Growth & Size
Rate: Not stated
Size: 3–6 ft (0.9–1.8 m) high × 3–6 ft (0.9–1.8 m) wide.
Dense, bushy Slow to Spreads by underground shoots

Sun

Water

Soil
Moderately fertile, moist but well-drained, humus-rich soil. Tolerates a range of soils

Zone 8a
Hardy in USDA Zones 6–9 (or 7–9). Suitable for Atlanta Zone 8a. Evergreen shrub with glossy dark green leaves. Intensely fragrant creamy-white flowers in winter (vanilla/honey scent). Black berries follow. Excellent for shade. Heat and humidity tolerant with adequate moisture. RHS Award of Garden Merit

ORIGIN AND CHARACTERISTICS

Origin
Probably native to western China (or a hybrid of Chinese species). Introduced to cultivation around 1916 (possibly from Wilson collections). Origin somewhat confused; not matched by wild specimens. RHS Award of Garden Merit

Form
Dense evergreen shrub. Glossy, deep green, wavy ovate leaves. Tiny creamy-white, highly fragrant flowers in winter. Glossy black berries. Bushy, mounding habit. Spreads slowly by suckers. Year-round structure. Attracts pollinators in winter. Outstanding shade evergreen with intensely fragrant winter flowers. Glossy foliage and black berries. RHS AGM. Excellent for Atlanta shade gardens. Low maintenance.
Origin somewhat confused but reliable in cultivation

Foliage
Not stated

Flowers and fruit
Not stated

Bark
Not stated

PLANTING NOTES

Establishment

Plant in part to full shade with moist, well-drained soil. Excellent near paths or entries for winter fragrance. Mulch to retain moisture. Minimal pruning needed. Low maintenance. Suitable for foundations, woodland edges, and containers

HEALTH

Health

Generally pest-free and low maintenance. Excellent shade performer. Fragrant winter flowers. Berries ornamental (not for consumption). May be susceptible to honey fungus in some conditions. No serious problems stated as dominant

Symptoms

None stated